

ROXANA GONZALEZ

1155 Lady St, Apt 407
Columbia, SC 29201
Phone: (931) 239-0433

Email: roxanag@email.sc.edu
Web: roxana-gonzalez.github.io
Citizenship: United States

EDUCATION

Expected May 2027	Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina
May 2022	B.A. in Economics, University of Tennessee (<i>Cum Laude</i>)

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Urban Economics, Public Economics, Large Language Models

JOB MARKET PAPER

“Outcomes of Property Tax Regressivity”

Sole-Authored

Abstract: Tax assessments are regressive with respect to house price for owner-occupied single-family homes in the United States, translating to higher effective tax rates for owners of cheaper homes (Amornsiripanitch 2024; McMillen & Singh 2019). I study whether this regressive property tax structure leads to worse outcomes for these households using a panel of property tax liabilities and transactions for all owner-occupied housing units in Mecklenburg County, North Carolina. Using Mecklenburg’s seven-year reassessment cycle to capture large changes in tax assessment values, I find that bottom-quartile homes sell at an 18 percent discount and see 64 percent more foreclosure filings two-to-three years after a reassessment, on average. I instrument for effective tax rates with years from reassessment to capture the share of the reassessment effect attributable to the property tax regressivity. I find that over half of the effects on sales prices and foreclosure filings can be explained by differences in effective tax rate changes post-reassessment. The effect is not driven by local unemployment cycles nor housing market trends specific to all bottom quartile-homes, suggesting that differential property tax burdens disproportionately affect owners of cheaper homes.

RESEARCH PAPERS

“Opportunity Zones & Housing Supply”

Sole-Authored

Under Review, Journal of Urban Economics

“What Can LLMs Tell Us About the ETI?”

with Jason DeBacker and Max Ghenis

“Opportunity for Affordability: Tax Incentives and Rental Housing Markets”

Sole-Authored

Recipient of the Best Third-Year Paper Award

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Effectiveness of Local Flavored E-Cigarette Bans”

with Kara Jones and Danna Thomas

HONORS, GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	SPARC Graduate Research Grant (\$5,000), University of South Carolina Office of Research
2026	Graduate School Travel Grant (\$800), University of South Carolina Graduate School
2025	Southeastern Annual Economic Conference Graduate Student Award (\$1,000)
2025	Melayne Morgan McInnes Memorial Award for Best Third-Year Paper (\$1,000), University of South Carolina Moore School of Business
2022	Summer Program Scholar, American Economic Association (AEA)
2018–2022	Pledge Scholar, University of Tennessee

PRESENTATIONS

2026	American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) International Conference, National Tax Association Conference (<i>accepted</i>)
2025	Southern Economics Association (SEA) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2024	Association for Public Policy and Management (APPAM) Annual Conference; American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference

TEACHING POSITIONS

Department of Economics, University of South Carolina Moore School of Business

Instructor of Record

Spring 2026 Introduction to Economics

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026 Professor Lois Miller

Spring 2025 Professor Sang Min Lee

Spring–Fall 2024 Professor Danna Thomas

Fall 2023 Professor Tamara Sheldon

RESEARCH POSTIONS

2025–2026	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Summer 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
Spring 2025	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
2024	Research Assistant to Professor Danna Thomas, University of South Carolina
Fall 2023	Research Assistant to Professor Crystal Zhan, University of South Carolina
2022–2023	Research Assistant to Professor Jason DeBacker, University of South Carolina
Spring 2022	Research Assistant to Professor Kin Blackburn, University of South Carolina
2021–2022	Research Assistant to Professor Maria Padilla-Romo, University of Tennessee

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Aug. 2025–Aug. 2026 Workforce Data Scientist (part-time), South Carolina Department of Employment and Workforce

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026 Job Market Boot Camp, American Economic Association (AEA) Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference
2025 Summer School in Urban Economics, Urban Economics Association, Tufts University
2024 Applied Data Analytics Training, Coleridge Initiative (confidential micro-data, record linkage, and machine learning)
2022 Summer Training Program, American Economic Association (AEA)

SKILLS

Statistical Software / Programming: Python, SQL, Stata, R
Quantitative Methods: Causal inference, regression, predictive modeling, machine learning
Data Skills: Collection, cleaning, validation, documentation, and dissemination of large datasets
Languages: English (fluent), Spanish (fluent)
Service: First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

SERVICE

First-Generation Graduate Mentor, University of South Carolina, 2024–2025

REFERENCES

Dr. Jason DeBacker

Full Professor of Economics
University of South Carolina
jason.debacker@moore.sc.edu
(770) 289-0340
Relationship: Graduate Research Advisor

Dr. Danna Thomas

Assistant Professor of Economics
University of South Carolina
danna.thomas@moore.sc.edu
(256) 452-7415
Relationship: Faculty Mentor

Dr. Orgul Ozturk

Full Professor of Economics
University of South Carolina
odozturk@moore.sc.edu
(803) 463-6168
Relationship: Faculty Mentor